PAWAR PUBLIC SCHOOL

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Subject:- History
Chapter :- Akbar the Great
Topic :- Questions and Answers

A. Picture Study.

1) Identify the monument shown in the picture.
Ans → The monument shown in the picture is Buland Darwaza.

2) Where is the monument located?
Ans → Buland Darwaza is located in Fatehpur Sikri.

3) Why was this monument built?
Ans → Akbar had built Buland Darwaza to commemorate his victory over Gujrat.

B. Answer these questions in brief.

1) When was the 2nd Battle of Panipat fought? Why was it significant?
Ans → The Second Battle of Panipat was fought between Bairam Khan [Akbar's regent] and Hemachandra Vikramaditya [Hemu] in November 1556. Hemu had seized control over Delhi and Ajmer, posing a serious threat to Mughal force. The defeat of Hemu ensured Akbar's throne.

2) Name the areas that were annexed by Bairam Khan's regency.

Ans → Delhi, Ajmer, Lahore, Multan, Jaipur, Gwalior were annexed by Bairam Khan's regency.

3) What were the main features of Akbar's policy towards the Rajputs?

Ans → The main features of Akbar's policy towards Rajputs:-

(i) Honour and Equality:- Akbar treated the Rajputs with respect. He inducted them into Mughal services

(ii) Positions :- Akbar appointed rajputs in a higher position. ex:- Raja Man Singh, one of the nine gems

(iii) Matrimonial alliance:- He had matrimonial alliance with daughter of Raja Bhar Mal & daughter of Raja Udai Singh

(iv) Religious Tolerance:- Akbar abolished jaziya. allowed subjects freedom of worship.

4) What was Akbar's religious policy?

Ans → • Akbar followed a liberal religious policy:-

(i) He abolished ~~jazia~~ jaziya, a tax paid by non-muslims.

(ii) He allowed his subjects freedom of worship & building of religious places.

(iii) He gave land grants, important military positions irrespective of their religious beliefs.

He realised that in order to rule over the diverse population, it is important to make sure everyone could enjoy equal status.

5) Why did Akbar abolish jaziya?

Ans → Akbar abolished jaziya because it was resented (disliked) by non-muslims. He believed that a ruler must gain the loyalty and support of all subjects.

6) What was the purpose of the Ibadat Khana?

Ans → Akbar built Ibadat Khana, hall of prayer at Fatehpur Sikri. He started a series of debates on finer points of religion with representatives [philosopher & scholars] of various religions. He had built this to understand the main points, principles and teachings of each religion.

7) What was the difference between Diwan-i-Am and Diwan-i-Khas?

Ans → Diwan-i-Am was a public audience hall, that means, this was the place where the emperor would meet his subjects to hear their pleas and grievances. On the other hand, Diwan-i-Khas was a private audience hall, that means, this was the place where he meet his ministers and councillors to take about the important state affairs.

8) Who were the Navaratnas?

Ans → The Navaratnas [the nine jewels] were the nine talented men in Akbar's court who helped him in administration, culture, art, and learning. They were Birbal, Todar Mal, Tansen, Abdul Faizl, Abdul Rahim, Raja Man Singh, Faizi, Fakir Aziao-din, Mullah-do-Piaza.

C. Answer these questions in detail.

1) Who was Bairam Khan? What role did he play in the consolidation of the Mughal Empire?

Ans → Bairam Khan was the most trusted official of Humayun. After Humayun's death, he served as Akbar's regent. He became the wakil (cheif minister) of the kingdom withe the tittle of Khan-i-Khana. Bairam Khan guided Akbar for conquering territories throughout India. He fought the second Battle of Panipat. He conquered Delhi, Lahore, Multan, Ajmer, Jaipur and Gwalior.

2) Which Rajput clan refused to submit to Akbar? What was the result of this opposition?

Ans → Rana Udai Singh, Maharana Pratap Singh and Amar Singh of the Sisodiya clan of Mewar refused to submit to Akbar. This opposition led to war between the mughals and the Rajput kings. Siege of Chittorgarh was fought between Rana Udai Singh and the mughal army wher Udai Singh fled and left Jai Mal in charge. Sisodiya's capital, Chittor, was captured in 1568 CE and Jai Mal was killed. The Rajput women performed jauhar. Dispite the loss of Chittor, Maharana Pratap (son of Udai Singh) fought the Battles of Haldighati with Man Singh (ally of Akbar). Maharana Pratap was defeated but escaped to the hills.

3) Who were mansabdar? Explain the mansabdari system.

Ans → The word mansab means position or rank. The mansabdari system was the basis of civil as well as military administration across the country. The mansab determined the status of mansabdar (it's holder) in the official hierarchy.

- The lowest mansabdars had to maintain 10 horsemen whereas the highest had to maintain 7000 horsemen.

- The highest mansabs were reserved for the members of the royal household
- All mansabdars were paid in cash/jagir.
- The holder of jagir was called jagirdar.
- The mansabdar were not hereditary.
- All appointments, transfers and dismissals were carried out by the emperor.

4) Who was the revenue minister in Akbar's administration? How did he reform the land revenue system under Akbar?

Ans → Raja Todal Mal was appointed as the revenue minister to reform the existing land revenue system establised by Sher Shah. This land revenue policy was popularly known as Toder Mal's Bandobast

- Land was measured with bamboo sticks joint with tanabs.
- After the measurment, the land was grouped into good, middling and bad, based on the period of cultivation of land.
- Then, the average produce was calculated.
- The land revenue was fixed at 1/3 of the average produce. Peasants could pay in cash or kind.
- The revenue officials needs to be lenient and gentle with farmers.
- The emperor granted remission of land revenue in times of flood.

5) List the main features of Akbar's central administration.

Ans → The main features of the central administration are:-

- Wazir/diwan:- Head of revenue and finance department.
- mir bakshi:- Head of the millitary department.
- mir saman:- supervised the purchase of all kinds of articles and their storage for royal household.

• qazi:- Head of the judiciary
• Sadr:- supervisor of the royal household
• The emperor meets his subjects in Diwan-i-Am to hear their pleas and grievances.
• while he met his ministers and councillors in Diwan-i-Khas to discuss the state affairs.

6) What social and cultural reforms were introduced by Akbar?

Ans → Social reforms
• He did not permit practice of sati
• Encouraged widow remarriage and discouraged child marriage.
• Promoted education in secular subjects like mathematics, history, agriculture, logic and astronomy.
• He ~~ea~~ established a translation department for sanskrit texts such as Vedas & Bhagvad Gita into Persian and Arabic

Art & cultural reforms
• Architecture:- He adopted several Indian styles in his architecture. He used Rajput style to built the city, Fatehpur Sikri.
• Literature:- Akbar asked Abdul Fazl to write a detailed account of his reign. Tulsidas wrote Ramcharitamanas.
• Music:- The court musician, Tansen, made Hindustani music rich.

7) Write a short note on Din-i-Ilahi.

Ans → Akbar had promulgated the idea of a new religion called Din-i-Ilahi. This was also known as Divine Faith. This has the main features from all religions. It was based on the principle of one god. It promoted the ideals of brotherhood and unity. It regarded the emperor as the representative of god on Earth. It was like a moral code. He never forced anyone to follow it. Among his Hindu nobles only Birbal accepted the religion. Din-i-Ilahi ended with the death of Akbar.

8) What steps were taken by Akbar to ensure that his empire was properly administered?

Ans → • Akbar was the supreme head of the empire.
• He was assisted by ministers such as Wazir, Mir Bakshi, Qazi. with each minister having defined duties, helping in smooth administration.
• He divided his empire into subas (provinces) with each having a subedar for easy administration.
• Villages were governed by village panchayat.
• Diwan was responsible for keeping records of land revenue
• The land was measured and tax was fixed according to fertility.
• He introduced Mansabdari System for basis of civil and military administration.
• Each mansabdar (according to mansab (rank)) had to maintain horsemen, and were paid salaries (jagirs) by jagirdars
• Akbar believed in religious tolerance, hence he removed the jizya system.

D. Write short notes.

1) Sulh-i-Kul

Ans → The discussions in Ibadat Khana led akbar to develop the ide of Sulh-i-Kul. Sulh-i-Kul also known as universal peace, was secular it outlook and did not discriminate people of differ religions. It aimed in promoting tolerance between people. It focused on honesty, justice and peace.

2) Rani Durgavati

Ans → Rani Durgavati was the regent of Gondwana, ruling on behalf of her minor son. She provided a tough resistance to the Mughal army. The mughal army was sent by Akbar to conquer Gondwana in 1564 CE. However, she was defeat. After the defeat, she stabbed and killed herself. And Gondwana was brought under Mughals.

6

Ans:-

3) Maharana Pratap

Ans → Maharana Pratap was a Rajput king who stood against Akbar. He belonged to the Sisodiya clan of Mewar. He was the son of Rana Udai Singh. The conflict began with Udai Singh, where Chittor was captured. Yet, Maharana Pratap didn't surrender. The 2 forces met again in 1576 CE at the Battle of Haldighati. Maharana Pratap was defeated, but escaped to the hills and continued his struggle.

4) Art and architecture during Akbar's regin.

Ans → Akbar was a great patron of art, literature and architecture. He used the Rajput style to built the city, Fatehpur Sikri. Some of the buildings are, Patch Mahal, Jodha Bai's Palace & Buland Darwaza. Most of these building are made out of redstone. He encouraged Persian literature. He asked Abul Fazl to write Akbarnama, a historical account of his reign. Birbal was bestowed by the tittle, Kavi Raj. The Hindustani music flourised by Tansen. The Mughal miniature paintings also flourised during his reign.